



CENTER FOR INTERNATIONAL MEDIATORS AND ARBITRATORS

— LONDON | ACCRA | DUBAI —



CIMA Summer School on International Arbitration

ACCRA, 2026

LAW, PRACTICE AND PROCEDURE
IN DOMESTIC & INTERNATIONAL
ARBITRATION



What is International Arbitration?

Gary Born conceives international arbitration essentially as:

“A consensual process by which parties submit a dispute to one or more non-governmental decision-makers, selected by or for the parties, to render a binding decision resolving that dispute”.

The key elements in Born’s conception are therefore consent, private/non-governmental adjudication, party participation in the constitution of the tribunal, and a binding determination.

Gary B. Born,
International Commercial Arbitration
(Kluwer Law International).

Dispute Resolution

Advisory Board Members International Arbitration



Francesco Campagna FCIMArb



Dr Osei Bonsu Dickson FCIMArb



Marieke Witkamp, FCIMArb, FCIMArb



Marco Casano



Kwasi Prempeh-Eck

How We're Shaping the Future of Dispute Resolution Responsibly

CIMA's global faculty brings together fellows, peers and experienced practitioners, many of whom undertook their advanced training in international commercial arbitration at Worcester College, Oxford. This depth of international training and practice informs a learning experience grounded in globally benchmarked standards, practical expertise and contemporary arbitral practice.

We are one of the world's leading advocates of online dispute resolution - we believe the future of dispute resolution will be more virtual, accessible, intelligent, internationally connected and technologically driven. CIMA advances excellence in arbitration, mediation and ADR through professional education, certification, thought leadership, institutional collaboration and responsible innovation. As technology reshapes legal practice, our position is clear: innovation must reinforce professional standards, procedural fairness and human judgement.

Our Principles

Dispute Resolution is Ultimately Human

Technology can enhance speed, efficiency and access, but it cannot replace the independence, judgement, empathy and professional responsibility central to effective dispute resolution. CIMA therefore develops its programmes in collaboration with practitioners, judges, academics and institutions across jurisdictions.

Technology Must Serve Justice

AI is transforming legal research, case management, drafting and dispute administration. CIMA promotes responsible AI that augments professional judgement whilst safeguarding due process, confidentiality, impartiality, transparency and meaningful human oversight.

Greater Access. Higher Standards.

CIMA broadens access to arbitration and mediation through professional training, certification, mentoring and international collaboration—creating pathways for both established and emerging practitioners whilst maintaining rigorous standards of competence and professionalism.

Innovation Must Be Responsible

Digital arbitration, ODR and AI-assisted dispute resolution present significant opportunities alongside challenges involving cybersecurity, data governance, algorithmic bias and accountability. CIMA advocates innovation founded upon transparency, competence, procedural integrity and responsible governance.

Building the Future

Through the CIMA AI Institute, professional education, research, technology initiatives and institutional partnerships, CIMA is helping develop practical frameworks for the responsible integration of technology into modern dispute resolution.

Our objective is to help create a global ADR ecosystem that is more accessible, efficient, representative and trusted—one in which technology strengthens human expertise rather than displaces it.

With members across more than 33 countries, CIMA is building an increasingly diverse and internationally connected community. Learn, Engage and Partner with us

CIMA Fellow Spotlight — Iain Sharp FCIArb, FCIMArb

As a CIMA Fellow and international faculty member, Iain contributes to the development of the next generation of arbitration practitioners through CIMA's professional programmes. Drawing upon his experience in Singapore—one of the world's foremost centres for international arbitration—he brings a distinctly practical and global perspective to CIMA's growing professional community across more than 33 countries.

Oxfordshire, England

Time Table

26 Aug - 4 Sept, 2026

DAY 1– WEDNESDAY, 26 2026

Time	Module /Level	Lecturer
9:00 – 10:15	Introduction to Arbitration and ADR (Associate)	Dr Osei Bonsu Dickson FCIMArb (CIMA)
10:25 – 10:30	Break	Break
10:30 – 11:55	Arbitration Agreements (Associate)	Dr Misha Kumar
11:55 – 12:00	Break	Break
2:00 – 3:15	Arbitration Case Management	Dr Misha Kumar
3:30– 4:45	Mediation Law and Practice	William Patrick McPhilamy, III

World-class education in arbitration and mediation, distinguished by hybrid learning, immersive practical exercises, and advanced mock hearing simulations.

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DAY 2 – THURSDAY, 27 AUG 2026

Time	Module /Level	Lecturer
9:00 – 10:15	Legal Framework (Associate)	Dr Osei Bonsu Dickson FCIMArb (CIMA)
10:25 – 10:30	Break	Break
10:30 – 11:45	Recognition and enforcement of Arbitral awards	Justice Dominic Dennis Adjei
11:45 – 12:00	Break	Break
2:00 – 3:15	Law of Obligations	Dr Osei Bonsu Dickson FCIMArb (CIMA)ty of London)
3:30 – 4:45	AI in Arbitration and Mediation	Isaac Maafo

DAY 3 – FRIDAY, 28 AUG 2026

Time	Module/Level	Lecturer
9:00 – 10:15	Arbitration Process and Institutional Rules	Mankiranjit Kaur FCI Arb (Malaysia)
10:25 – 10:30	Break	Break
10:30 – 11:55	Arbitration in Practice (Nigeria)	Ms Abasiemediong Etuk
12:00 – 01:00	Break	Break
02:00 – 3:15	Mock Arbitration and Mediation	Dr Osei Bonsu Dickson FCIMArb
3:15– 3:30	Accra Arbitration Roles, LCIA and UNICITRAL	Dr Kolawole Mayomi

DAY 4 – 7 SAT 29 AUG 2026 - TUE 4 SEPT 2026

Day 4 (30 th May)	Group Activity	Venue
Day 4	Practical Exercises, Individual Assignments and Group Work	CIMA House / Designated Venue / Virtual
Day 5	Group Activity	CIMA House / Designated Venue / Virtual
	Practical Exercises, Individual Assignments and Group Work	CIMA House / Designated Venue / Virtual
Day 6	Arbitral Team Practicals	CIMA House / Designated Venue / Virtual
	2026 Africa Mock Arbitration Series	CIMA House
Day 7	2026 Africa Mock Arbitration Series	CIMA House

2026 Africa Mock Arbitration Series

The Africa Mock Arbitration Series is a flagship practical advocacy and dispute resolution initiative of the Center for International Mediators and Arbitrators designed to develop a new generation of highly skilled African arbitration practitioners, advocates, tribunal secretaries, mediators, and arbitral professionals.

Conceived as a bridge between theory and practice, the programme provides participants with immersive exposure to the realities of domestic and international arbitration through simulated arbitral proceedings modelled on leading global arbitral institutions and contemporary African commercial disputes.

Unlike traditional academic moot competitions, the CIMA Africa Mock Arbitration Series is deliberately structured as a professional practice-oriented platform combining:

- Arbitration advocacy,
- Procedural strategy,
- Memorial drafting,
- Tribunal management,
- Award writing,
- Negotiation,
- Mediation,
- and Hearing advocacy.

LAW PRACTICE AND PROCEDURE IN DOMESTIC AND INTERNATIONAL ARBITRATION

The CIMA Spring Academy 2026 is a high-level hybrid arbitration training programme (i.e. virtual and in-person) bringing together leading international arbitration practitioners, judges, academics, and ADR professionals from the United Kingdom, Malaysia, Nigeria, Kenya, India, United States, Ghana, and Bosnia Herzegovina.

The programme runs from 26 August – 4 Sept 2026 and combines intensive academic instruction with practical arbitral training, mock proceedings, and advocacy exercises.

Associate Level (ACIMArb)

The Associate programme runs daily from 9:00 am – 12:30 pm GMT and provides participants with practical foundations in arbitration and ADR. Key modules include Introduction to Arbitration and ADR, Arbitration Agreements, Legal Framework, Arbitration Procedure, Constitution and Powers of the Tribunal, and Ethics, Cybersecurity and Artificial Intelligence in ADR.

Member Level (MCIMArb)

The Fellowship programme runs daily from 12:00 pm – 4:00 pm GMT. Participants have 1 month to complete dissertation and its focuses on advanced international arbitral practice.

Practical Activities

The first 3 days involve virtual training. Participants can join from anywhere in the world. From Days 4 – 7, participants will undertake hybrid – virtual and in person arbitral and mediation work:

- Practical exercises
- Individual assignments
- Group work
- Mock arbitrations
- Mock mediation sessions

These practical sessions will be held at CIMA House and designated venues.

CIMA Summer School on International Arbitration

Benefits

Participants will:

- Gain practical and internationally relevant arbitration skills
- Learn directly from leading global arbitration experts
- Develop advocacy and award-writing competence
- Acquire exposure to international institutional rules and procedures
- Build international professional networks
- Participate in practical mock proceedings
- Enhance career opportunities in arbitration, mediation, and dispute resolution

Upon successful completion, participants become eligible for the internationally recognised post-nominals ACIMArb and MCIMArb (England & Wales), subject to the applicable requirements.

CIMA Materials and Resources for Participants

Participants of the CIMA Spring Academy 2026 will receive comprehensive training materials and practical resources during and after training, designed to support learning and professional arbitral practice. These include:

- Course slides, Practical arbitration templates and precedents
- Sample arbitration agreements and procedural orders
- Mock arbitration and mediation problem materials
- Award writing guides and specimen arbitral awards
- Comprehensive reading materials at the CIMA website (www.thecima.org)
- Access to selected institutional rules and procedural frameworks
- Dissertation and legal research guidance materials

Associates and Global Interns from Asia are encouraged to sit in on the respective lectures in order to enhance their knowledge and deepen their understanding of contemporary international arbitration and ADR practice.

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WILLIAM PATRICK MCPHILAMY, III

William Patrick McPhilamy, III works in the legal services space as a lawyer, mediator, and arbitrator in his firm, McPhilamy-ADR, based in the Los Angeles Metropolitan Area. He has expertise in dispute resolution and alternative dispute resolution. His practice areas include civil, commercial, corporate, and intellectual property law, among others.

He is an accredited mediator and a chartered arbitrator. He is the Resident Representative of California for ADR ODR International. He is a Senior Fellow and Fellow of several international alternative dispute resolution centers. He has previously served as a judge or expert assessor for numerous mediation, arbitration, and negotiation competitions in the U.S. and internationally, and a judge or expert assessor for several national trial competitions in the U.S. He received his mediation and negotiation training from the Law School, Business School, and Kennedy School at Harvard University, and graduated from the University of Cambridge with a Master of Law degree.



HIS LORDSHIP JUSTICE DENNIS ADJEI S.FCIMArb

(Justice, Supreme Court of Ghana)

Justice Dennis Dominic Adjei is a distinguished Ghanaian jurist, arbitration scholar, and dispute resolution practitioner. He is a Justice of the Supreme Court of Ghana, a Justice of the African Court on Human and Peoples' Rights, and was a member of the Advisory Committee of the International Criminal Court.

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He was elected the University of London Inns of Court and Advanced Legal Studies Senior Judges Fellow for Common Law Jurisdictions for the 2022–2023 academic year. He is also a Fellow of the Ghana Academy of Arts and Sciences (FGA) and a Senior Fellow of CIMA (S.FCIMArb).

Justice Adjei was called to the Ghana Bar in 1993 after studying at the University of Ghana and the Ghana School of Law. He holds advanced qualifications from GIMPA, the University of London, and Duke University School of Law. He has served as Acting Director of the Judicial Training Institute of Ghana, having previously held the substantive role from 2014 to 2019. He also served as Dean of the Faculty of Law, GIMPA, from 2019 to 2020.

He teaches as an adjunct academic at the Ghana School of Law, the University of Cape Coast, and KNUST, with expertise in statutory interpretation, land law, conveyancing, criminal law, and dispute resolution.

Justice Adjei is the author of several leading Ghanaian legal textbooks, including works on constitutional law, statutory interpretation, criminal procedure, land law, and criminal law. He also co-authored *Alternative Dispute Resolution: A Ghanaian Perspective*. In recognition of his service, he was knighted by Pope Emeritus Benedict XVI into the Order of St Gregory the Great in 2005.



DR OSEI BONSU DICKSON FCIMArb

(Global Vice President, CIMA)

Dr Osei Bonsu Dickson FCIMArb is an international arbitration practitioner and lawyer, legal scholar, and cybersecurity law expert. He serves as Global Vice President of the Center for International Mediators and Arbitrators, Founding Partner at Lex Mundus & Cencla PRUC, and Editor-in-Chief of the *World Arbitration Review*. He is a Fellow of CIMA (FCIMArb), member of the London Court of International Arbitration (LCIA), and member of the New York State Dispute Resolution Association (NYSdra).

Dr. Dickson previously served as Chief Legal Advisor at Ghana's National Security Council Secretariat and is the Immediate Past President of the In-House Lawyers Forum of the Ghana Bar Association. He is also an Adjunct Lecturer at the University of Ghana School of Law and a frequent speaker at international conferences on arbitration, cybersecurity law, dispute resolution, and governance.

He holds advanced training in international commercial arbitration from the Chartered Institute of Arbitrators at Oxford University, and has authored several scholarly works, including writings on international arbitration, cybersecurity, and dispute resolution reform in Africa. His current work focuses on international commercial arbitration, institutional ADR development, digital dispute resolution, and the advancement of the Accra Arbitration Rules. He was educated at the University of Ghana, the Ghana School of Law, Harvard University and Rushford Business School.

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MANKIRANJIT KAUR FCI Arb
(Director, National Legal Academy, Malaysia)

Mankiranjit Kaur is a highly regarded legal professional in Malaysia, currently serving as Director of the National Legal Academy. Her career is defined by a deep commitment to the Malaysian legal and judicial systems, having held significant roles such as Head Legal Advisor for the Ministry of Entrepreneur Development and Cooperatives Malaysia and Senior Federal Counsel at the Attorney General's Chambers. Her past roles also include being a Magistrate, Deputy Registrar of the Court of Appeal and Deputy Public Prosecutor.

Beyond her domestic civil service, Mankiranjit is also an internationally recognized expert in Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR). She is a Fellow of the Chartered Institute of Arbitrators (FCI Arb) and serves as an international arbitrator and adjudicator on the panel of the Asian International Arbitration Centre (AIAC), Brunei and other jurisdictions. Her academic background includes a Master of Laws (LLM) from the University of Malaya and a Diploma in Global International Commercial Arbitration from CIARB conducted at University of Oxford, thereby positioning her as a leading voice in complex global legal advocacy and judicial training. She is a seasoned lecturer both at home and abroad. In recognition of her excellence service, she was recently awarded the Special Award Certificate by the Ministry for her bold initiatives in protecting the legal frameworks of Malaysian entrepreneurs and cooperatives.



DR MISHA KUMAR FCI Arb
(Managing Partner, MMK Law Chambers, India)

Dr. Misha Kumar, FCI Arb, is a distinguished Indian lawyer, arbitrator, and mediator based in New Delhi. She is the Founder and Managing Partner of MMK Law Chambers, where she provides specialist legal counsel and dispute resolution services in commercial, corporate, and international matters. Dr. Kumar has extensive experience in international arbitration, commercial mediation, litigation, and advisory practice. She regularly appears before leading judicial and quasi-judicial forums in India, including the Supreme Court of India, the Delhi High Court, the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal, and the National Company Law Tribunal.

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She serves as Panel Counsel for the Union of India before the Supreme Court of India, representing various government ministries, statutory authorities, and public bodies. Her practice reflects a strong blend of courtroom advocacy, institutional representation, and alternative dispute resolution expertise. A Fellow of the Chartered Institute of Arbitrators, United Kingdom, Dr. Kumar is actively engaged in global arbitration and mediation discourse.

She is also a member of the Arbitration Bar of India and contributes to professional discussions on arbitration agreements, commercial dispute resolution, and the development of modern ADR practice. Since 2025, Dr. Kumar has served as a Distinguished International Speaker for CIMA, contributing her expertise to CIMA's global programmes and thought-leadership initiatives in arbitration, mediation, and international dispute resolution. 1.



MS ABASIEMEDIONG ETUK, MC Arb

Ms Abasiemediong Etuk, MC Arb, is a senior associate at KENNA specialising in international and domestic arbitration, capital markets, and corporate governance and regulatory compliance. She brings considerable experience in navigating the legal, procedural, and strategic complexities of arbitral proceedings, including institutional and ad hoc arbitrations across a range of commercial and investment disputes.

She has represented local and international clients in complex, high-stakes disputes, drawing on a deep understanding of industry-specific issues, applicable arbitral rules and frameworks, and the negotiation dynamics critical to achieving favourable outcomes.

In addition to her work in arbitration, she advises Nigerian and international clients in both the public and private sectors on corporate governance matters, ensuring adherence to best practices, regulatory requirements, and evolving compliance standards. She leverages her transactional and regulatory expertise to bring a commercially informed perspective to dispute-resolution mandates.

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DR SIMON PETER TSEKPO

(Vice President, Kings University, Ghana)

Dr. Simon Peter Tsekpo is Vice President of Kings University College. He is an accomplished academic administrator, researcher, and institutional leader with over eighteen years' experience in higher education governance, academic planning, institutional development, and research supervision.

His professional background reflects a strong commitment to scholarly excellence, rigorous academic standards, and the development of effective research practice. He holds two PhDs in Management. His teaching and research interests include thesis and dissertation writing and supervision, corporate governance, institutional sustainability, financial systems, higher education development, and management practice in West Africa.

As faculty for Thesis and Dissertation Writing, he brings considerable experience in guiding students through the research process, including topic development, literature review, methodology, analysis, argumentation, academic writing, and scholarly presentation.



DR KOLAWOLE MAYOMI FCI Arb, FCIM Arb

(Partner, SPA Ajibade, Nigeria)

Dr Kolawole Mayomi is a Partner in the dispute resolution practice of S. P. A. Ajibade & Co. He is a prize-winning graduate of the Faculty of Law, Obafemi Awolowo University, Ile-Ife, and also holds an LLM from the same University. He was called to the Nigerian Bar in 2003, and had his legal pupillage in the Chambers of Chief I. N. Umezuruike, SAN (Aba).

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He subsequently gained extensive litigation experience with some leading Nigerian commercial law firms. Kolawole has been involved as counsel in many high stakes arbitration disputes that have taken place in Nigeria over the past decade, and is particularly noted for his expertise in handling complex claims arising from construction and infrastructural projects, trade finance, and shareholders derivative rights.

Kolawole is widely considered to be a thought-leader on the law relating to guarantee obligations in Nigeria, and has authored many articles/book chapters on this subject. In addition, he has advised several banks and construction companies on the nature of the payment obligation arising from demand guarantees, performance bonds, advance payment guarantees etc. Kolawole is a Trustee of the Society for Construction Law Nigeria, and a Fellow of the Chartered Institute of Arbitrators. He is a Fellow of both the Chartered Institute of Arbitrators and Center for International Mediators and Arbitrators.



MICHAEL SMITH

Michael Smith is a CIMA Global AI lecturer with a particular interest in the practical application of artificial intelligence to law and dispute resolution. At the CIMA Summer School on International Arbitration, he examines the growing role of AI across the arbitral process, including legal research, case analysis, document management and emerging questions of ethics, confidentiality and professional responsibility.

His recent work examines how emerging technologies are reshaping legal research, case strategy, evidence and decision-making. At the CIMA Summer School, he addresses a compelling question for the future of arbitration: as AI becomes increasingly capable, where should human judgement remain indispensable?

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DAVID ASIEDU, FCI Arb

David A. Asiedu, FCI Arb, is a distinguished dispute-resolution lawyer with 23 years' experience in commercial litigation and international commercial arbitration. His experience spans complex disputes across various sectors such as energy, construction, telecommunications, media, and broader commercial sectors.

A Fellow of the Chartered Institute of Arbitrators (CI Arb), David has been recognised by leading international legal directories for his work in dispute resolution and international arbitration. David was also the lawyer responsible for establishing the commercial dispute practice of the erstwhile Oxford & Beaumont Solicitors (now ENS Ghana) where he was a partner for 14 years.

He brings immense hands-on experience as arbitration law lecturer and practitioner to the 2026 CIMA Summer School on International Arbitration.

Beyond his legal practice, David is passionate about mentoring young lawyers and professionals. Over the years, he has invested considerable time in training, coaching, and supporting young practitioners in areas such as legal writing, advocacy, professional development, productivity, and career growth. He is committed to helping the next generation of professionals develop not only strong technical skills, but also clarity of thought, confidence, discipline, and sound professional judgment.

CIMA – Trusted by Global Law Firms and International Organizations

Professionals from some of the world's leading law firms and organisations have earned dual fellowship or undertaken CIMA (UK) training and earned CIMA professional certification.

Pinsent Masons, Hong Kong	S & A Law and Consultancy
Lex Mundus & Cencla PRUC, Ghana	F-X Law and Associates
SPA Ajibade, Nigeria	Ranga Reddy District Court
Maldives Moot Court Society, Maldives	Edfields Attorneys
World Bank	Nkunim chambers
National Legal Academy, Malaysia	PM legal bureau
SOAS University of London, United Kingdom	Ahmed's Consult
Supreme Court of Ghana	Ecobank Ghana PLC
Commonwealth Lawyers Association, United Kingdom	A & N Law Consult
World Arbitration Review, United Kingdom	UGMC
AB David Africa	University of Cape Coast legal affairs
Arbitra International, United Kingdom	BOST Energies Limited Company
Eversheds Sutherland LLP, Ireland	Architectural and Engineering S
Francois & Associates, Ghana	Dankus ADR and Paralegal Center
Said Al Shanny & Partner (Oman)	Office of the Special Prosecutor
Hill Dickinson, Singapore	Trent Legal Chambers
HAS Law Firm, UAE	Amissah, Amissah & Co
H-Law Firm, India	Atta Poku Law consult
Legal Vidhaya, India	Creative Giants
Ministry of Justice and Attorney General's Dept., Ghana	Trinitas Law Consult
Peter D. Maynard Counsel & Attorneys, The Bahamas	Ghana Interbank Payment
Gamey and Gamey Group	National Communications Authority
Economic and Organised Crime Office	W.S.D. Consulting Limited
Ghana Health Service	AELEX
Asempa, Bediako & Co	Asempa Chamers
Liberia Electricity Corporation	No 5 Barristers Chambers
Dayesmann & Lexwell	Landmark Legal
Teas2cheese	SSNIT
Deloitte Ghana	Nyahe Law Consult
Ecobank Ghana PLC	Judicial Service
Afagbe Law and Company Unlimited	De meideros and Associates
Landmark Attorneys	Integrated Legal Consultants
Ecam Law Consult	Firmus Advisory
Amarteifio & Co.	Ministry of Finance, Ghana
Asare Barimah and Associates	Jimma University
Citadel Law Consult	Bank of Ghana
Ghana School of law	Quality Control Company Ltd
Eagle AB & K Law	

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and International Organizations**

Cyrus Law PRUC	Harem Jalal Khoshnaw
Feli Tetteh Enterprise	Oseawuo Chambers
Haramaya University	Dayesmann & Lexwell
The Law Office of Kwainoe	Dayesmann & Lexwell
Asiamah, Offei & Co PRUC	Haramaya University
Osei Kofi Legal Consult	Kumasi Technical University
Law Plus Attorneys-at-Law	NellyK Tech Consult, Abuja Nigeria
Law Faculty, Central University	CBG
Yekentrans Consult	Appiah-Nkyi Legal Consult
Sarpsolutions Ltd	Afagbe Law and Company
Ghana Revenue Authority	Citadel Law Consult
Stanbic Bank Ghana Ltd	SSNIT
Blackgold Arbitration	Aone Justitia
Dankus ADR and Paralegal Center	Ghana Air Force (Ministry of Defence)
Quality Control Company Ltd	Korsah and Acker and ecobank
UPSA Law school	Telecel legal Department
Citizens Centre of Mediation and Arbitration	Africa Institute of Small Scale Mining
TDC Ghana Ltd	Legal Aid Commission
Gurah Sampson @ Law	KNUST, Kumasi
Hybrid Montessori	Fuzzy1963 Consult
Chemico Ltd	National Health Insurance Authority
Ameta Chambers	Ghana Ports and Harbours Authority
Almeida & Associados	Dominion Legal and Resolution Partners, a Division of Trinity Vision Ventures
Trent legal	Vordoagu, Dzeble & Co
Legal Aid Commission	Parliament House
Sterling Les Consult	Oppong and Associate
International Legal Foundation-Af	Lexkudoz Legal Consultants
Exusia Law Consult	Doe-Legists Lawyers
Justice for Advocacy and the Arabic	Google
Ghana Police Service	Oxford University
Shahid and partners,the law firm	Huawei Technologies
Ghana Air Force Hq	
ADB Plc	
Army Training Command	
Sam Okudzeto and Associates	
Fuzzy1963 Consult	
National Health Insurance Authority	
Ghana Ports and Harbours Authority	

The CIMA Fellows: Leaders in Global Dispute Resolution



DAVID GREENE FCIArb, FCIMArb (UK)

Former President, Law Society of England & Wales
Senior Partner, Edwin Coe (United Kingdom)

Distinguished Leadership: 176th President, Law Society of England and Wales (2020–2021)

Became a CIMA Fellow: 2026

Former Leadership: President, London Solicitors Litigation Association
International Role: Chair, Human Rights Committee, Commonwealth Lawyers Association

Professional Fellowship: Fellow, Chartered Institute of Arbitrators

Recognition: Law Society's Legal Personality of the Year; Solicitors' Journal Rule of Law Award

Areas of Practice: Commercial Litigation • International & Domestic Arbitration • Class & Group Actions • Civil Fraud & Asset Recovery • Financial Services Disputes • Judicial Review & Public Law

International Experience: Has worked on disputes and arbitrations involving jurisdictions across Africa, Europe, the Caribbean and the United States, and has advised sovereign states in international disputes.

CIMA Distinction: Formally invested as a CIMA Fellow in Accra in January 2026.

The CIMA Fellows: Leaders in Global Dispute Resolution



EFUA GHARTEY, FCIMArb (UK)

President, Ghana Bar Association
Managing Partner, Gharthey & Gharthey (Ghana)

Firm: Gharthey & Gharthey

Called to the Ghana Bar: 1991

Became a CIMA Fellow: 2026

Professional Standing: 30+ years at the Bar

Historic Distinction: First female President of the Ghana Bar Association

Former Leadership: President, Greater Accra Bar

ADR Leadership: Member, Governing Board of the Ghana ADR Centre

Areas of Practice: Corporate & Commercial Law • Investment Law • Corporate Litigation • Company Law • Maritime Law • Labour & Employment • Alternative Dispute Resolution • Private Client Practice

Court Experience: Has appeared before all levels of Ghana's courts, including the Supreme Court.

CIMA Distinction: Formally invested as a CIMA Fellow in Accra in January 2026.

Why Lawyers needs Arbitration, Mediation and Litigation Skills

The modern lawyer can no longer afford arbitral blindness. He it she cannot view litigation, arbitration and mediation as competing disciplines. They are complementary components of an integrated dispute-resolution architecture. Commercial disputes increasingly involve cross-border transactions, complex contractual relationships, multiple jurisdictions and sophisticated dispute-resolution clauses. Effective counsel must therefore understand not merely how to conduct proceedings, but which process—or combination of processes—best protects the client’s legal, commercial and strategic interests.

Litigation skills remain fundamental. They develop rigorous legal analysis, advocacy, evidence management, procedural discipline and the ability to obtain and enforce judicial remedies. Yet court proceedings are not invariably the optimal commercial response. Arbitration competence equips lawyers to navigate party autonomy, tribunal constitution, jurisdictional objections, applicable law, procedural flexibility, interim measures and the recognition and enforcement of awards—particularly important where transactions and assets cross national boundaries.

Mediation adds a different but equally important professional capability. Whereas litigation and arbitration principally determine legal rights, mediation enables counsel to identify commercial interests, manage risk and structure negotiated outcomes that a court or tribunal may lack jurisdiction to order. Lawyers trained in mediation develop sophisticated skills in negotiation, communication, option generation and settlement strategy. These competencies are especially valuable where parties have continuing business relationships or where an early commercial resolution may preserve value that prolonged adjudication could destroy.

The strongest dispute-resolution lawyer must therefore not simply be a litigator, arbitrator or mediator, but a multi-process strategist capable of moving intelligently between negotiation, mediation, arbitration and litigation. Modern dispute clauses increasingly reflect this reality through tiered and hybrid mechanisms. Lawyers who understand the full dispute-resolution continuum are better positioned to diagnose disputes, select appropriate processes, manage procedural risk and deliver commercially intelligent outcomes. The future belongs to counsel who understand not only how to fight a dispute, but when to arbitrate, when to mediate, when to litigate—and when to combine them.

Why Non-Legal ADR Professionals need Arbitration and Mediation Skills

Disputes are not exclusively legal problems. They arise daily in business, construction, banking, energy, technology, maritime operations, employment, procurement and international trade. Managers, engineers, accountants, entrepreneurs and other professionals are frequently involved long before lawyers enter the picture. Understanding arbitration and mediation enables them to identify disputes early, manage risk and make commercially informed decisions.

Mediation skills strengthen negotiation, communication and problem-solving. They help professionals distinguish between positions and underlying interests, manage difficult conversations and structure practical settlements while preserving valuable commercial relationships. These are increasingly important leadership and management competencies.

Arbitration knowledge is equally valuable. Professionals who understand arbitration agreements, evidence, contractual obligations, expert testimony and arbitral procedure are better equipped to negotiate contracts, administer projects, preserve records and work effectively with legal counsel when disputes arise.

Arbitration and mediation training therefore extends beyond preparing people to become arbitrators or mediators. It develops dispute intelligence—the ability to anticipate conflict, prevent escalation, negotiate effectively and participate intelligently in formal dispute-resolution processes. In modern business, that is not merely a legal skill; it is a strategic professional advantage.

10 Things you can do with CIMA Arbitration and Mediation Credentials

1. Act as an Arbitrator - determine commercial and contractual disputes independently and impartially.
2. Practise as a Mediator - facilitate negotiated settlements between disputing parties.
3. Represent Parties in Arbitration - serve as counsel or party representative in domestic and international proceedings.
4. Represent Parties in Mediation - develop negotiation strategies and advocate effectively during settlement processes.
5. Become a Dispute-Resolution Consultant - advise businesses and institutions on dispute prevention, management and resolution.
6. Draft Effective Dispute-Resolution Clauses - design arbitration, mediation and multi-tier dispute clauses for commercial contracts.
7. Work with Arbitral Institutions - pursue opportunities in case management, tribunal administration and institutional ADR.
8. Become a Negotiation & Conflict-Management Specialist - apply mediation techniques to workplace, corporate and commercial conflicts.
9. Develop a Specialist ADR Practice - build expertise in areas such as construction, maritime, energy, technology, banking or international trade disputes.
10. Build an International ADR Career - participate in professional panels, conferences, teaching, research, publications and cross-border dispute-resolution networks.

Advisory Board Members
International Arbitration
Oxfordshire

Partners



LEX MUNDUS
& CENCLA

Arbitration & ADR





CENTER FOR INTERNATIONAL
MEDIATORS AND ARBITRATORS

— LONDON | ACCRA | DUBAI —

GLOBAL OFFICE

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Ghana

CIMA HOUSE

World Law Building
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Ghana

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